Lab 2 - Activity 2 - Hermes Desktop, Tools, Skills & the Company Brief

Day 1 | Topic 2 | 90 min | Single agent | LO1

Meet Kopi Kaki at the start of the company labs; onboard one Hermes office worker.

Goal

Install Hermes Desktop, load reviewed office/video skills, verify tools and produce the source-linked company brief (LO1/LO2).

The business scenario

You are Kopi Kaki Co.'s Marketing Lead. The Gula Melaka Cold Brew launches on 1 Dec and you have 60 unread customer reviews, a competitor list and no analyst. You 'hire' Mia - a Hermes Agent marketing analyst - onboard her with the company context, and ask for a research brief that tells you which campaign angle to run.

You will deliver

- outputs/lab01/review-insights.md - ratings, themes and evidence (review IDs)
- outputs/lab01/research-brief.md - trends, competitors, 3 campaign angles with evidence
- Mia's long-term memory holds the brand facts and YOUR chosen angle (recalled in a new session)
- Skill installation and tool-version evidence for gog-office, office-analytics, interactive-dashboard, professional-ppt and launch-video

Who does what

- Agents: 1 Hermes agent - 'Mia', AI marketing analyst
- You (the human): Set the goal, challenge the evidence, choose the campaign angle

Before you start

- Download the official Hermes Desktop installer for your OS: https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/desktop
- Trainer-approved model access, preflighted native Python, gog, FFmpeg and PPT/PDF renderer
- Approved course skills/data downloaded; preserve existing AGENTS.md; do not copy credentials into the workspace

Concepts in action

- Perception (files + web) → Brain (LLM reasoning, memory) → Action (write files)
- AGENTS.md = context the agent loads automatically (context engineering)
- Short-term memory (this session) vs long-term memory (MEMORY.md, recalled next session)
- Human-in-the-loop: the agent recommends, the human decides

Lab files (data/)

File	What it is
AGENTS.md	Company context Hermes loads automatically
brand-guide.md	Brand voice, colours, platform formats
campaign-brief.md	Gula Melaka Cold Brew campaign brief (offer, KPIs, timeline)
compliance-rules.md	C1-C10 brand-safety and escalation rules
product-catalogue.csv	12 products and prices
customer-reviews.csv	60 synthetic customer reviews
competitors.csv	6 fictional competitors
assets/brand-palette.png	Brand image asset
assets/cold-brew-product-card.png	Brand image asset
assets/kopi-kaki-logo.png	Brand image asset
campaign-data.xlsx	
skills/gog-office/SKILL.md	Agent skill (SKILL.md)
skills/office-analytics/SKILL.md	Agent skill (SKILL.md)
skills/interactive-dashboard/SKILL.md	Agent skill (SKILL.md)
skills/professional-ppt/SKILL.md	Agent skill (SKILL.md)
skills/launch-video/SKILL.md	Agent skill (SKILL.md)
tools/office_artifacts.py	
tools/render_launch_video.py	
windows-office-setup.md	
mac-linux-office-setup.md	
approved-test-send.md	

All company data in this lab (Kopi Kaki Co., people, reviews, comments, metrics, competitors) is fictional and generated for training.

Copy-ready prompts: `COPY-PROMPTS.txt` or the course Lab Prompts page. Printable instructions: `LAB-02-Instructions.pdf`.

Steps

1. Download and install Hermes Desktop (preferred)

Open https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/desktop in your browser. On macOS choose the Mac download and open the DMG, then install and launch Hermes. On Windows choose the Windows download, run Hermes-Setup.exe and launch Hermes. Follow normal OS installation prompts. Linux learners use the official terminal installation route linked on the page. Record the app/backend version shown by the installed app; do not install a second CLI checkout unless the trainer identifies a real need.

□ Expected: The native Hermes Desktop app opens on the learner computer. The selected connection/profile is local and its version is recorded.

2. Connect a model in the desktop app

Use the Desktop provider/account configuration and the trainer-approved provider to complete sign-in. Choose the model provided for class and send a short test message. Verify a real model response and inspect visible tool activity. A free app download does not guarantee free model/API usage.

□ Expected: The selected local profile gives a real model-backed reply; credentials stay in the app's configuration.

3. Open the launch workspace in Desktop

Create the kopi-kaki workspace in your own user folder and copy the lab data into it. Preserve any existing AGENTS.md. Use the Desktop file browser/workspace context or explicitly give the full folder path in chat, then ask Hermes to list the approved files before analysing them. On Windows stay in the native Desktop runtime; WSL has a different filesystem, PATH and credential store unless explicitly connected. On macOS/Linux, after copying this activity's data contents into the confirmed workspace, use data/mac-linux-office-setup.md to create the per-workspace .office-venv required below. Windows uses data/windows-office-setup.md. Verify imports in this exact environment before running any office/video helper.

```
cd ~/kopi-kaki
python3 -m venv .office-venv
.office-venv/bin/python -m pip install openpyxl python-pptx Pillow
.office-venv/bin/python -c "import openpyxl, pptx, PIL"
gog --version
ffprobe -version
```

Prompt - paste into *Hermes Desktop chat*:

```
Work in my kopi-kaki workspace at <replace with its full local path>. List campaign-brief.md,
brand-guide.md and customer-reviews.csv. Confirm the workspace path and selected local profile
before doing any analysis. Do not open or print credentials.
```

□ Expected: The Desktop agent can actually read the three files in the intended local workspace.

4. Inspect and install reviewed skills (15 min)

In Desktop open Skills for the selected local profile. Inspect the source and SKILL.md of each supplied course skill: gog-office, office-analytics, interactive-dashboard, professional-ppt and launch-video. Review commands, dependencies, permissions and output paths. Use the current app's local-folder install/import control; if using CLI, inspect hermes skills --help and the profile Skills path first, then copy each reviewed folder there. Do not assume every profile uses ~/.hermes/skills. Reload and confirm the five skills are listed. Source-qualified Hub installs are an optional alternative only after source review and scan. Skills instruct; gog/Python/FFmpeg execute; OAuth grants access.

Prompt - paste into *Hermes Desktop chat in the Kopi Kaki workspace*:

```
Inspect only the five reviewed course skills in my explicit workspace. Report each purpose,
required executable, allowed reads/writes and output. Run harmless version/import probes for
installed tools and report missing dependencies. Do not install arbitrary packages, run
unreviewed scripts or print credentials.
```

□ Expected: Five reviewed skills visible in the selected profile; actual dependencies and capabilities checked.

5. Create the source brief and human decision (25 min)

Prompt - paste into *Hermes Desktop chat in the Kopi Kaki workspace*:

```
Work in the confirmed Kopi Kaki workspace. Read brand-guide.md, campaign-brief.md, compliance-
rules.md, customer-reviews.csv and competitors.csv (fictional internal notes). Use tools to
calculate rating counts and identify top praise/complaint themes with counts and review_ids.
Save outputs/lab01/review-insights.md. Write outputs/lab01/research-brief.md with a short
summary, three campaign angles, evidence IDs, a risk for each and Decision needed. Do not
invent market statistics. Ask me to select an angle; save my choice and reason in the brief
and only the approved decision in persistent memory.
```

□ Expected: The shared Day 2 source brief exists and ends with an explicit human decision.

6. Verify persistence and native runtime (10 min)

Inspect the approved memory entry, then start a fresh chat with the same local profile and explicit workspace. Ask which angle you chose and why, and whether the answer used persisted memory or source/session search. Optional extension: Messaging → Telegram → Create with QR; verify numeric allowlist, restart if requested and use the existing gateway for one private round trip. Telegram is optional in v2.3; it does not replace the morning assistant screenshot.

□ Expected: Fresh-session recall checked; source IDs and decision agree.

Verification / checkpoint

[ ] Desktop uses the intended native local profile and approved provider

[ ] Five reviewed skills and actual required tools verified; installation alone does not prove output

[ ] review-insights.md and research-brief.md cite source IDs and contain the human decision

[ ] Approved decision is verified in persistence and a fresh session

Checkpoint: One native Hermes agent, five reviewed skills and a source-linked company brief; human decision persists.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
hermes: command not found	Open a new terminal or run source ~/.zshrc (macOS) / source ~/.bashrc (Linux/WSL2).
Model errors / context too small	Re-run hermes setup (or hermes model) and choose a model with ≥ 64k context.
Web search not available	Run hermes tools and enable the web toolset. Keyless search works for light use; for reliability add a free key, e.g. hermes config set TAVILY_API_KEY tvly-... (you reuse it on Day 2).
Windows paths	On native Windows Hermes keeps its data in %LOCALAPPDATA%\hermes instead of ~/.hermes - or run the labs inside WSL2.
Mia ignores the brand rules	Make sure you started hermes inside ~/kopi-kaki so AGENTS.md is loaded.
Bot is silent	Check allowed numeric ID, bot token entry, gateway status and network. Ensure no second gateway is polling this bot.
Telegram cannot find files	Use the full ~/kopi-kaki workspace path; gateway session directory can differ from the CLI session.
Desktop, CLI and Telegram see different files	Check selected connection/profile, workspace and runtime. Native Windows and WSL do not automatically share tokens, skills or paths.

Stretch challenge

Ask Mia: "Save the review-analysis procedure you just used as a reusable skill called review-insights." Then run hermes skills list - a self-improving agent turns experience into procedural memory.

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